Report of the law enforcement conference in Budapest 2013

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It's been a few years since the infamous meeting of the European parliament and the council of the European Union in 2011. Even since then it was for us ,law enforcement, a rise in arresting and putting criminals who help children pornography behind bars. Since technically they didn't " have " to hide it , we managed to arrest those who weren't prepared or didn't see anything wrong with their activities.

I want to speak about a case with no following today. On December 15 2011, exactly 2 days after the meeting of the union , we received a letter with a collection of pictures. Photographs of what we identified as 16 or 17 year old boy being, what we assume raped by 3 different men from the signs of struggles and restrains on the boys arms and possibly the abuse of substance from the strap on his arm. But the identity of this boy knows no name. Why ? This photograph dates from 1915-16 . It is in poor condition, the photograph itself at least.

Because this photograph was kept safe, washed in chemicals to remove any print we assume, the borders were cut and blued back on a different paper.. . . Why so much care ?

The boy in this picture would be around 113 today, if he lived that long of course. During my internship in the archive I couldn't get past this strange case. Why would someone keep such a perfectly well kept photograph ?

And, assuming the person who kept this picture did not take the picture (same thing, could not live as long) , why would such photograph be kept as a heritage ? This envelope, which was not bought by any company. It's a handmade envelope, with shredded paper mixed in water then dried and put back together, and had to be handled with care . So this little heritage must have been known thought the generations.

What we wonder is the original function of such a photograph ? We assume because of the context that it must have been some kind of blackmail , perhaps against the boy in the picture. But if it IS blackmail , why not use it during the time the boy must have been alive ? Why keep it longer ? Did the owner of the photograph die before being able to use it ?

But then , the owners' children, who are the ones who probably restored the photograph because of the techniques , why did they keep it still ? Working in law enforcement, of course I teach you no lesson that some people don't have all wires connected.

But still why keep your grandparents blackmailing children pornography photographs ? For sick entertainment? Or to black mail perhaps the same boy now old or even children of this boy ? So we would be dealing with a century old rivalry ?

If it is a rivalry then why stop now ? Would such rivalry be scared of a few articles about child protection ? If the blackmailed family revealed the blackmail , of course , the blackmail family would know some juridical conséquences but also the blackmail would be revealed so both parties would lose something.

but such blackmail wasn't revealed to any police station or service after the pass of the council, it was given to us. No address, no way to find where it comes from , who gave it , one day it just appeared here.

Did the person suddenly, after years of keeping this treasure safe, get scared ? Did this person understand the weight of holding on onto such entertainment ? or was it simply worth nothing anymore ? Having blackmail that is illegal is just useless , the blackmailed will be considered victim and pitied , no one will side with the one who blackmailed.

Again , why give it to law enforcement ? Did this person know it was untraceable ? Did they get bored ? In some way there was still a will of preservation, perhaps they knew that it would be a pending case, impossible to reopen but too big to close it and destroy the evidence.

Thank you for your time.